

Fossil Gen 6 Smartwatch

Being one of the first smartwatches to be built using the Snapdragon Wear 4100+ SoC, the Fossil Gen 6 can easily boast of having more horsepower than the competing Android Wear devices. However, hardware is only one half of the equation. When it comes to the software part, Fossil seems to be lagging since the smartwatch is yet to get the latest Wear OS version. So your apps will run faster but the way it functions and the features you have access to are practically the same as its previous iterations. Mind you, it's not like there are no smartwatches in the market which aren't running the latest Wear OS. And since we've got a faster processor, there's obviously going to be the question regarding battery life. We managed to get a good day out of the Fossil Gen 6 and for

Android Wear devices, that's pretty decent. However, in the world of smartwatches where you have custom OS devices running for a good 7-10 days on standby, this seems a bit lacking. But that's the trade-off one makes to get access to a much more versatile feature set thanks to Wear OS.

The health sensor array has additional sensors than what we saw on the Fossil Gen 5. And the array continues to be a little protruded to allow for more accurate readings. As for the GPS on the device, it's a little off. We walked 12 kilometers with the Fossil Gen 6 and a Garmin Forerunner and the Fossil Gen 6 would track an addi-



tional kilometer over the Garmin. To see which device was more accurate, we charted the path that we'd taken on Google Maps and measured the distance. The Garmin was way closer to the actual distance than the Fossil device so the GPS functionality could do with a little tweaking. Overall, the

Fossil Gen 6 is a great smartwatch with powerful hardware and hopefully, it will receive the latest Wear OS soon to provide a much better experience. However, if you're a fitness nut and would like an accurate tracker for your runs, then you might want to get another device.
PRICE: ₹23,995

Sennheiser XSW-D Portable Lav Kit

With content creation at an all-time high, especially content creation on smartphones, it has become imperative to have good sound to go with good video production. Sennheiser with their XSW-D Portable Lav Kit has made things extremely easy and it's quite the value-for-money proposition as well.

Let's begin with what you get out of the box. You get the Lav mic with a transmitter and receiver module and both have built-in batteries that can be charged via USB-C. Next is the Manfrotto Pixi Mini tripod and the spring-loaded adjustable phone holder built out of machined aluminium. You also get a cold shoe mount to hold the receiver and a transmitter mount that can be attached to your waist. Also included are the 3.5mm TRRS and TRS cables along with the USB-C charging cable. All components are extremely well built and you totally get your money's worth with each of them.

Getting started with using the mic is relatively simple once you figure out what the lights on the receiver and trans-

mitter mean and all it takes to get the mic ready for use is pressing the button on the receiver and transmitter modules. It works on a 2.4GHz frequency band and we tested the mic first in an empty room that did not have any sound treatment. It did pick up a bit of white background noise but while speaking it would pick up speech extremely well and clearly. Similarly, when used in an outdoor environment, ambient noise was picked up quite prominently and

so a gain control app would be handy while using it with a smartphone. It shouldn't be a problem if used with a camera though as most cameras have built-in options to control gain. Next, we tested the range and found that without a clear line of sight, the microphone would have signal cuts around 7.5 meters and with a clear line of sight the signal was strong even at 20 meters.

The XSW-D Portable Lav Mobile Kit is one versatile microphone. It can benefit both, beginners and professionals alike. For anyone looking for a hassle-free, easy to use lav mic, this is certainly one to consider.

PRICE: ₹28,500

